

DCAT-US 3.0: questions and answers

Prepared 5 October 2026 for a briefing to the Office of Management and Budget.

How these answers were made. Each answer was drafted by one AI model reading only the passages quoted in the attachment, and each sentence was then checked against the passages it cites by a different AI model. A sentence the check could not confirm was removed, not reworded. For questions 9, 12 and 13, the check also asked whether each sentence answers the question, and a sentence that does not was removed too. The attachment quotes every passage the answers rely on.

“Not found in the sources” lists what the documents collected for this briefing do not say. Each item was checked against the passages gathered for its question and against a second search of the same documents using the item's own words. An item means the search did not find it; it does not mean that no document anywhere says it.

Requirement levels name the version of the page they were read from. The DCAT-US 3.0 Dataset page as served on 5 October 2026 gives every element the same requirement level as the 15 September 2026 capture (table in the attachment). Text in parentheses after an answer sentence was added by code, not by a model: it gives each named element's level in every version of the Dataset page, or says whether a passage quoted from an earlier capture is still on the page as served on 5 October 2026.

1. What is DCAT-US 3.0, and how does it relate to W3C DCAT 3?

DCAT-US v3.0 is the federal data catalog metadata standard, updated to improve the Findability, Accessibility, Interoperability, and Reusability (FAIRness) of federal data. [1][2] (The same text is on the page as served 5 October 2026.) It is a U.S. application profile of W3C DCAT version 3, not a new or separate standard, so most DCAT-US v3.0 metadata is valid W3C DCAT 3 metadata. [1][2] (The same text is on the page as served 5 October 2026.) OMB memorandum M-25-05 states the OMB-approved standard metadata schema will conform to the United States profile of the W3C Data Catalog Vocabulary Version 3, known as DCAT-US 3.0. [3]

Sources:

1. DCAT-US 3.0 Overview (resources.data.gov). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-08-21. What is DCAT-US v3.0. <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us3/>
2. DCAT-US Schema v3.0 (overview and reference). GSA. 2026-05. passage 7. <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us3/>
3. M-25-05: Phase 2 Implementation of the Foundations for Evidence-Based Policymaking Act of 2018: Open Government Data Access and Management Guidance. OMB. 2025-01-15. passage 104. <https://bidenwhitehouse.archives.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/M-25-05-Phase-2-Implementation-of-the-Foundations-for-Evidence-Based-Policymaking-Act-of-2018-Open-Government-Data-Access-and-Management-Guidance.pdf>

2. Who developed it, and what was FCSM's role (the FAIRness Project)?

GSA's DCAT-US v3.0 overview pages state it was developed collaboratively by the Federal Chief Data Officers Council, the Federal Committee on Statistical Methodology, and the Data.gov team at GSA. [1][2] (The same text is on the page as served 5 October 2026.) The FAIRness Project wiki says the Federal Chief Data Officer Council, in partnership with FCSM, is leading the project, whose outcome will be an updated federal metadata standard for agency data inventories. [3] A 2024 FCSM conference presentation names the project co-chairs as Thomas Dabolt of Interior and Michael Ratcliffe of the Census Bureau, for the CDO Council and FCSM. [4]

Not found in the sources:

- What specific tasks FCSM performed within the project beyond partnering with the CDO Council to lead it and co-chairing it.
- Whether FCSM formally approved or adopted the final DCAT-US v3.0 schema.

Sources:

1. DCAT-US 3.0 Overview (resources.data.gov). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-08-21. What is DCAT-US v3.0. <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us3/>
2. DCAT-US Schema v3.0 (overview and reference). GSA. 2026-05. passage 8. <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us3/>
3. Welcome to the CDOC/FCSM FAIRness Project (DCAT-US 3 project wiki, Home). CDOC/FCSM FAIRness Project (GitHub DOI-DO/dcat-us wiki). 2023-10-26. Welcome to the CDOC/FCSM FAIRness Project. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/wiki/DOI-DO/dcat-us/Home.md>
4. The FAIRness Project: Building Trust and FAIRness into Finding and Using Government Data (FCSM 2024 Research and Policy Conference, session B3.3). Thomas Dabolt (DOI); Michael Ratcliffe (U.S. Census Bureau). 2024-10-30. https://statspolicy.gov/assets/fcsm/files/docs/2024-conference-docs/B/B3.3_Dabolt.pdf

3. What does policy require of agencies, and by when (M-25-05, the Evidence Act's inventory requirements)?

The Implementation Guide says Title II of the Evidence Act and M-25-05 direct each agency to develop and maintain a comprehensive data inventory and submit metadata to Data.gov's Federal Data Catalog by September 30, 2026. [1] M-25-05's action table sets September 30, 2026 for inventory data asset listings updated to DCAT-US 3.0, and requires the inventory hosted publicly at [www.\[agency\].gov/data.json](http://www.[agency].gov/data.json). [2] M-25-05 also says agencies must update the inventory no later than 90 days after creating or identifying a data asset, and within one year if the schema changes. [2]

Not found in the sources:

- What consequences apply to an agency that misses the September 30, 2026 date.
- When Data.gov stops harvesting DCAT-US v1.1 data.json files at the end of the transition period.
- Whether any extension or waiver of these deadlines is available to agencies.

Sources:

1. DCAT-US v3.0 Schema Implementation Guide, version 1.1. Federal CDO Council. 2026-08-21 (version 1.1, 2026-09-09). passage 70. <https://resources.data.gov/assets/documents/dcat-us-3-implementation-guide.pdf>
2. M-25-05: Phase 2 Implementation of the Foundations for Evidence-Based Policymaking Act of 2018: Open Government Data Access and Management Guidance. OMB. 2025-01-15. Sections: Section 4(a) (ii); Section 6; passage 92; passage 103. <https://bidenwhitehouse.archives.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/M-25-05-Phase-2-Implementation-of-the-Foundations-for-Evidence-Based-Policymaking-Act-of-2018-Open-Government-Data-Access-and-Management-Guidance.pdf>

4. Which elements are Mandatory, Recommended and Optional, and what did v1.1 require that 3.0 does not?

The DCAT-US 3.0 Dataset page captured on 15 September 2026 lists title, description, identifier and contactPoint as Mandatory. [1] On that same capture, publisher, keyword, modified, distribution and rights are Recommended, while accrualPeriodicity, issued, language, accessRights and conformsTo are Optional.

[1] The v1.1 schema required accessLevel always, bureauCode and programCode for federal agencies, and publisher, keyword and modified always; the 15 September 2026 page drops the first three and makes the rest Recommended. [1]

Not found in the sources:

- Why publisher is Mandatory on the 21 August 2026 Dataset page but Recommended on the 15 September 2026 capture.
- The full list of elements at each requirement level in a single summary.

Sources:

1. Requirement level of each Dataset element in four versions of the schema, read from each version's text (table in the attachment). Read from: DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov; Internet Archive capture 2026-09-15, after the September 2026 rewrite), 2026-09-15 https://web.archive.org/web/20260915131436id_/https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/; DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov), 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/>; DCAT-US - Version 3: Data Catalog Application Profile for the United States of America (Candidate Recommendation Snapshot; Internet Archive capture 2025-05-04), 2025-05-04 https://web.archive.org/web/20250504194000id_/https://doi-do.github.io/dcat-us/; DCAT-US Schema v1.1 (Project Open Data Metadata Schema) - resources.data.gov, 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us/>.

5. What did FCSM and the FAIRness Project recommend for findability and for assessing fitness for use?

The FAIRness Project describes a strategic two-year sequencing plan to improve and integrate government-wide metadata cataloging so users can easily find, access, assess for fitness-for-use, and use federal data. [1][2] FCSM 19-01 states that transparent reporting is achieved when an agency provides clear and detailed documentation so users can assess data quality, that is fitness for use, for themselves. [3] FCSM 25-03 says enriching data access points with high-quality metadata and standardized, AI-friendly APIs can significantly improve how large language models discover, interpret, and relay publicly available federal statistics. [4]

Not found in the sources:

- The key findings and recommendations contained in the FAIRness Project's sequencing plan, which was provided to the Office of Management and Budget with no public copy located.
- Which DCAT-US v3.0 fields FCSM or the FAIRness Project recommended for carrying fitness-for-use information, or at what requirement level.

Sources:

1. FAIRness Project: Project Overview (DCAT-US GitHub wiki). Federal CDO Council and FCSM. 2023-09-12. Introduction. <https://github.com/DOI-DO/dcat-us/wiki/Project-Overview>
2. The FAIRness Project: Building Trust and FAIRness into Finding and Using Government Data (FCSM 2024 Research and Policy Conference, session B3.3). Thomas Dabolt (DOI); Michael Ratcliffe (U.S. Census Bureau). 2024-10-30. https://statspolicy.gov/assets/fcsm/files/docs/2024-conference-docs/B/B3.3_Dabolt.pdf
3. FCSM 19-01: Transparent Reporting for Integrated Data Quality. Prell M; Chapman C; Adeshiyan S; Fixler D; Garin T; Mirel L; Phipps P. n.d. https://statspolicy.gov/assets/fcsm/files/docs/Transparent_Reporting_FCSM_19_01_092719.pdf

4. FCSM 25-03: AI-Ready Federal Statistical Data: An Extension of Communicating Data Quality. FCSM. 2025-05. Sections: Challenge & Opportunity; passage 31. https://statspolicy.gov/assets/fcsm/files/docs/FCSM.25.03_AI-Ready-Extension-Data-Quality.pdf

6. Which of those recommendations reached the Mandatory or Recommended tiers, and which did not?

contactPoint reached Mandatory: the 2025 working draft gave it Recommended, and both DCAT-US 3.0 Dataset pages, August and September 2026, list it as Mandatory. [1] Quality measurement did not rise: hasQualityMeasurement is Optional in the 2025 working draft and Optional on both the August and September 2026 Dataset pages. [1] geographicBoundingBox was Recommended in the 2025 working draft but is not listed on either DCAT-US 3.0 Dataset page. [1]

Not found in the sources:

- What the FAIRness Project's sequencing plan recommended, as no public copy exists and it was provided only to OMB.
- Who set these requirement levels, or why an element's tier differs between the working draft and the published Dataset pages.
- Whether the elements the September 2026 page newly lists as Recommended, such as accessRestriction and license, came from any earlier recommendation.

Sources:

1. Requirement level of each Dataset element in four versions of the schema, read from each version's text (table in the attachment). Read from: DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov; Internet Archive capture 2026-09-15, after the September 2026 rewrite), 2026-09-15 https://web.archive.org/web/20260915131436id_/https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/; DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov), 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/>; DCAT-US - Version 3: Data Catalog Application Profile for the United States of America (Candidate Recommendation Snapshot; Internet Archive capture 2025-05-04), 2025-05-04 https://web.archive.org/web/20250504194000id_/https://doi-do.github.io/dcat-us/; DCAT-US Schema v1.1 (Project Open Data Metadata Schema) - resources.data.gov, 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us/>.

7. What changed between the public working draft and the published schema?

The 2025 working draft listed contactPoint and publisher as Recommended, while the Dataset page as captured on 21 August 2026 lists both as Mandatory. [1] The published Dataset pages list elements the working draft did not, including created, rightsHolder, supportedSchema, wasAttributedTo and wasUsedBy, all Optional. [1] (Level by version, created, rightsHolder, supportedSchema, wasAttributedTo and wasUsedBy: Optional on the Dataset page captured 21 August and 15 September 2026 and as served 5 October 2026.) Three properties the working draft listed as Recommended or Optional, geographic bounding box, next and prev, are not listed on either published Dataset page. [1]

Not found in the sources:

- Why any of these changes were made between the working draft and the published schema.
- What changed between the working draft and the published schema for classes other than Dataset.

Sources:

1. Requirement level of each Dataset element in four versions of the schema, read from each version's text (table in the attachment). Read from: DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov; Internet

Archive capture 2026-09-15, after the September 2026 rewrite), 2026-09-15 https://web.archive.org/web/20260915131436id_/https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/; DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov), 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/>; DCAT-US - Version 3: Data Catalog Application Profile for the United States of America (Candidate Recommendation Snapshot; Internet Archive capture 2025-05-04), 2025-05-04 https://web.archive.org/web/20250504194000id_/https://doi-do.github.io/dcat-us/; DCAT-US Schema v1.1 (Project Open Data Metadata Schema) - resources.data.gov, 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us/>.

8. How does 3.0 represent data quality, and how does that map to the FCSM Framework for Data Quality (FCSM 20-04)?

The DCAT-US 3.0 Dataset page lists hasQualityMeasurement as Optional, holding quality measurements such as completeness, accuracy, or timeliness beyond spatial or temporal resolution. [1] (Level by version, hasQualityMeasurement: Optional on the Dataset page captured 21 August and 15 September 2026 and as served 5 October 2026; the same text is on the page as served 5 October 2026.) On the Temporal, Spatial, and Metrics page, a QualityMeasurement gives a value, a unitMeasure, and an isMeasurementOf metric whose inDimension names a dimension URL. [2] FCSM 20-04 groups dimensions into utility (relevance, accessibility, timeliness, punctuality, granularity), objectivity (accuracy and reliability, coherence), and integrity (scientific integrity, credibility, computer and physical security, confidentiality). [3]

Not found in the sources:

- Any mapping or crosswalk between DCAT-US 3.0 quality measurements and the FCSM Framework's domains or dimensions.
- Any required or recommended vocabulary of dimension values for inDimension, including whether FCSM dimension identifiers exist.
- Whether DCAT-US 3.0 quality reporting satisfies any FCSM 20-04 data quality documentation or reporting expectation.

Sources:

1. DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-08-21. Sections: DCAT-US 3.0: Dataset; Dataset > hasQualityMeasurement. <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/>
2. DCAT-US 3.0: Temporal, Spatial, and Metrics (resources.data.gov). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026. Class QualityMeasurement. <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/temporal-spatial-metrics/>
3. FCSM 20-04: A Framework for Data Quality. FCSM. 2020-09. Sections: passage 386; passage 397. https://statspolicy.gov/assets/fcsm/files/docs/FCSM.20.04_A_Framework_for_Data_Quality.pdf

9. Can 3.0 carry what statistical users need: series, dimensions, units, uncertainty (margins of error, CVs), methodology and revisions?

For series, the DCAT-US 3.0 overview page dated 21 August 2026 says v3.0 adds a DatasetSeries class grouping datasets published over time, with Dataset records pointing back using the inSeries field. [1] (The same text is on the page as served 5 October 2026.) For revisions, the Dataset page as served on 5 October 2026 lists two Optional version fields: previousVersion, a reference to the previous dataset version, and versionNotes. [2] On dimensions, the 2025 Candidate Recommendation says only that DCAT 3 and the RDF Data Cube specification introduce new vocabulary terms to describe statistical datasets and their dimensions. [3]

Not found in the sources:

- That the published DCAT-US 3.0 schema carries vocabulary terms for statistical dimensions.
- Any DCAT-US 3.0 field for margins of error, coefficients of variation, or other uncertainty measures.
- Any DCAT-US 3.0 field for statistical methodology documentation.

Sources:

1. DCAT-US 3.0 Overview (resources.data.gov). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-08-21. What's new in v3.0. <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us3/>
2. DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov; as served 2026-10-05). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-10-05. DCAT-US 3.0: Dataset. <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/>
3. DCAT-US - Version 3: Data Catalog Application Profile for the United States of America (Candidate Recommendation Snapshot; Internet Archive capture 2025-05-04). DOI-DO DCAT-US working group (GitHub doi-do/dcat-us). 2025-05-04. Gaps with DCAT-US 1.1. https://web.archive.org/web/20250504194000id_/https://doi-do.github.io/dcat-us/

10. Where do the documents disagree with each other: the schema pages, the Implementation Guide, the M-25-05 crosswalk, M-25-05 itself, and secondary accounts? For example, is the language code ISO 639-1 or BCP 47?

On language the documents agree on ISO 639-1 two-letter codes, and the Overview's changelog says its own earlier BCP 47 description was an error corrected in May 2026. [1][2][3] (The same text is on the page as served 5 October 2026.) The Overview disagrees with itself on accrualPeriodicity: its structural-changes table accepts three vocabularies and prefers plain-language codes, while its glossary says plain English descriptions cause validation failures. [1] (Quoted from the Overview as captured 21 August 2026; the page as served 5 October 2026 does not contain this text.) The Dataset page as captured on 15 September 2026 lists publisher as Recommended, while the 21 August 2026 version lists it Mandatory and the 2025 working draft says Recommended. [4]

Not found in the sources:

- Which language code standard M-25-05 itself requires.
- Any element where the M-25-05 crosswalk differs from the schema pages or the Implementation Guide.
- What any secondary account says about the language code.

Sources:

1. DCAT-US 3.0 Overview (resources.data.gov). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-08-21. Sections: Changelog; Structural changes; Glossary. <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us3/>
2. DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-08-21. DCAT-US 3.0: Dataset. <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/>
3. DCAT-US v3.0 Schema Implementation Guide, version 1.1. Federal CDO Council. 2026-08-21 (version 1.1, 2026-09-09). <https://resources.data.gov/assets/documents/dcat-us-3-implementation-guide.pdf>
4. Requirement level of each Dataset element in four versions of the schema, read from each version's text (table in the attachment). Read from: DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov; Internet Archive capture 2026-09-15, after the September 2026 rewrite), 2026-09-15 https://web.archive.org/web/20260915131436id_/https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/; DCAT-US 3.0 Schema: Dataset (resources.data.gov), 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/standards/catalog/dcat-us-3/dataset/>; DCAT-US - Version 3: Data Catalog Application Profile for the United States of America

(Candidate Recommendation Snapshot; Internet Archive capture 2025-05-04), 2025-05-04 https://web.archive.org/web/20250504194000id_/https://doi-do.github.io/dcat-us/; DCAT-US Schema v1.1 (Project Open Data Metadata Schema) - resources.data.gov, 2026-08-21 <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us/>.

11. How does DCAT-US 3.0 relate to AI readiness of statistical data (FCSM 25-03; the AI-readiness framework's indicators)?

FCSM 25-03 tells agencies to use common schemas or standards like the DCAT metadata standard used in data.gov catalogs, or SDMX, so AI developers have a consistent experience. [1] The DCAT-US v3.0 Schema Implementation Guide says adopting the schema aligns with the administration's AI priorities, because more descriptive metadata conveys context, structure, and lineage AI models need to interpret data correctly. [2] One framework indicator, G4, treats issuing authority as machine-readable catalog metadata: publisher, which DCAT-US 3.0 defines as Recommended, or DCAT-US 1.1's required bureauCode and programCode. [3] (Level by version, publisher: Mandatory on the Dataset page captured 21 August 2026, Recommended on the 15 September 2026 capture and as served 5 October 2026.)

Not found in the sources:

- That FCSM 25-03 names the DCAT-US v3.0 schema specifically, as opposed to the DCAT metadata standard generally.
- How the AI-readiness framework's other indicators map to DCAT-US 3.0 classes or fields.
- That DCAT-US 3.0 or its implementation guidance cites FCSM 25-03.

Sources:

1. FCSM 25-03: AI-Ready Federal Statistical Data: An Extension of Communicating Data Quality. FCSM. 2025-05. Sections: Approach (p.3); passage 39. https://statspolicy.gov/assets/fcsm/files/docs/FCSM.25.03_AI-Ready-Extension-Data-Quality.pdf
2. DCAT-US v3.0 Schema Implementation Guide, version 1.1. Federal CDO Council. 2026-08-21 (version 1.1, 2026-09-09). passage 85. <https://resources.data.gov/assets/documents/dcat-us-3-implementation-guide.pdf>
3. The presenter's own draft AI-readiness framework for federal statistical publishers (unpublished; the indicator's text is quoted in the attachment). Indicator G4.

12. What did the EU do for statistical data (StatDCAT-AP), and does the US have an equivalent?

The EU produced StatDCAT-AP, an extension of its DCAT Application Profile for data portals in Europe, for describing statistical datasets, dataset series and services. [1] On the US side, the 2025 Candidate Recommendation snapshot of DCAT-US 3.0 says DCAT 3 and the RDF Data Cube specification introduce new vocabulary terms describing statistical datasets and their dimensions more effectively. [2]

Not found in the sources:

- That the United States has a separate statistical application profile equivalent to StatDCAT-AP.
- That the published DCAT-US 3.0 schema carries the enhanced handling of statistical data described in the Candidate Recommendation snapshot.
- That DCAT-US 3.0 defines dedicated properties for statistical dimensions and attributes like the ones StatDCAT-AP created in its own namespace.

Sources:

1. StatDCAT-AP - DCAT Application Profile for description of statistical datasets, Version 1.0.1. European Commission, ISA2 programme / SEMIC Support Centre. 2019-05-28. https://interoperable-europe.ec.europa.eu/sites/default/files/distribution/access_url/2019-05/0812e528-c428-4832-b674-d5b9c68d1b42/StatDCAT-AP_1.0.1.pdf
2. DCAT-US - Version 3: Data Catalog Application Profile for the United States of America (Candidate Recommendation Snapshot; Internet Archive capture 2025-05-04). DOI-DO DCAT-US working group (GitHub doi-do/dcat-us). 2025-05-04. Gaps with DCAT-US 1.1. https://web.archive.org/web/20250504194000id_/https://doi-do.github.io/dcat-us/

13. What options exist for next steps? Examples: a statistical application profile; raising requirement levels through guidance; conformance checking. State what each source supports. Do not recommend beyond the sources.

On a statistical application profile, the StatDCAT-AP specification says it is an extension of the European DCAT Application Profile for describing statistical datasets, dataset series and services. [1] On guidance, the DCAT-US v3.0 Schema Implementation Guide says the tiger team elevated outstanding recommendations to OMB and the Federal Chief Data Officers Council for potential incorporation into future updates. [2] On conformance checking, the Overview page as served on 5 October 2026 says v3.0 is a valid JSON Schema 2020-12 and offers data.gov's online validator. [3]

Not found in the sources:

- That a statistical application profile of DCAT-US 3.0 exists, is planned, or is under development.
- That requirement levels such as Recommended can be raised to Mandatory through guidance.
- Whether the published DCAT-US 3.0 schema uses SHACL-based conformance checking alongside JSON Schema validation.
- Which of these options OMB or the Federal Chief Data Officers Council has selected, scheduled, or funded.

Sources:

1. StatDCAT-AP - DCAT Application Profile for description of statistical datasets, Version 1.0.1. European Commission, ISA2 programme / SEMIC Support Centre. 2019-05-28. https://interoperable-europe.ec.europa.eu/sites/default/files/distribution/access_url/2019-05/0812e528-c428-4832-b674-d5b9c68d1b42/StatDCAT-AP_1.0.1.pdf
2. DCAT-US v3.0 Schema Implementation Guide, version 1.1. Federal CDO Council. 2026-08-21 (version 1.1, 2026-09-09). passage 59. <https://resources.data.gov/assets/documents/dcat-us-3-implementation-guide.pdf>
3. DCAT-US 3.0 Overview (resources.data.gov; as served 2026-10-05). U.S. General Services Administration / Data.gov. 2026-10-05. Sections: What's new in v3.0; Validation. <https://resources.data.gov/resources/dcat-us3/>

14. What questions can the current sources not answer? List each, with the document that would answer it if one is known.

Each row is one gap left in the answers above, with the questions it affects and the document that would answer it, where one is known.

Gap	Questions	Document that would answer it
What specific tasks FCSM performed within the project	2	None known

Gap	Questions	Document that would answer it
beyond partnering with the CDO Council to lead it and co-chairing it.		
Whether FCSM formally approved or adopted the final DCAT-US v3.0 schema.	2	None known
What consequences apply to an agency that misses the September 30, 2026 date.	3	None known
When Data.gov stops harvesting DCAT-US v1.1 data.json files at the end of the transition period.	3	None known
Whether any extension or waiver of these deadlines is available to agencies.	3	None known
Why publisher is Mandatory on the 21 August 2026 Dataset page but Recommended on the 15 September 2026 capture.	4	None known
The full list of elements at each requirement level in a single summary.	4	None known
The key findings and recommendations contained in the FAIRness Project's sequencing plan, which was provided to the Office of Management and Budget with no public copy located.	5, 6	Implementing DCAT-US 3.0 Sequencing Plan (Federal CDO Council and FCSM, 5 August 2024; not published, see below)
Which DCAT-US v3.0 fields FCSM or the FAIRness Project recommended for carrying fitness-for-use information, or at what requirement level.	5	Implementing DCAT-US 3.0 Sequencing Plan (Federal CDO Council and FCSM, 5 August 2024; not published, see below)
Who set these requirement levels, or why an element's tier differs between the working draft and the published Dataset pages.	6, 7	None known

Gap	Questions	Document that would answer it
Whether the elements the September 2026 page newly lists as Recommended, such as accessRestriction and license, came from any earlier recommendation.	6	Implementing DCAT-US 3.0 Sequencing Plan (Federal CDO Council and FCSM, 5 August 2024; not published, see below)
What changed between the working draft and the published schema for classes other than Dataset.	7	None known
Any mapping or crosswalk between DCAT-US 3.0 quality measurements and the FCSM Framework's domains or dimensions.	8	None known
Any required or recommended vocabulary of dimension values for inDimension, including whether FCSM dimension identifiers exist.	8	None known
Whether DCAT-US 3.0 quality reporting satisfies any FCSM 20-04 data quality documentation or reporting expectation.	8	None known
That the published DCAT-US 3.0 schema carries vocabulary terms for statistical dimensions.	9, 12	None known
Any DCAT-US 3.0 field for margins of error, coefficients of variation, or other uncertainty measures.	9	None known
Any DCAT-US 3.0 field for statistical methodology documentation.	9	None known
Which language code standard M-25-05 itself requires.	10	None known
Any element where the M-25-05 crosswalk differs from the schema pages or the Implementation Guide.	10	None known

Gap	Questions	Document that would answer it
What any secondary account says about the language code.	10	None known
That FCSM 25-03 names the DCAT-US v3.0 schema specifically, as opposed to the DCAT metadata standard generally.	11	None known
How the AI-readiness framework's other indicators map to DCAT-US 3.0 classes or fields.	11	None known
That DCAT-US 3.0 or its implementation guidance cites FCSM 25-03.	11	None known
That the United States has a separate statistical application profile equivalent to StatDCAT-AP.	12, 13	None known
That requirement levels such as Recommended can be raised to Mandatory through guidance.	13	None known
Whether the published DCAT-US 3.0 schema uses SHACL-based conformance checking alongside JSON Schema validation.	13	None known
Which of these options OMB or the Federal Chief Data Officers Council has selected, scheduled, or funded.	13	None known

Documents known to exist and not used:

- *Building Trust and FAIRness into the Process for Finding and Using Government Data Project (FAIRness Project): Implementing DCAT-US 3.0 Sequencing Plan*. Federal CDO Council and FCSM, 5 August 2024. Provided to OMB and not published; a public request for it (DOI-DO/dcat-us issue #214, 2024-07-15) is open and unanswered.
- *The FAIRness Project (briefing to the National Geospatial Advisory Committee, April 2024)*. Federal CDO Council and FCSM, April 2024. Public; not reviewed for this briefing.